Ben Siverly

PRODUCT MANAGER · TWO-SIDED PRODUCTS, PAYMENTS & DATA

Technical PM · Recovering Data Scientist · Decisions in writing

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EXPERIENCE

AppFolio · *Product Manager, Rental Applications*

Jan 2023 – Oct 2026

Property-management software. The rental application is where both sides meet: 9M+ applicants a year, 23,000+ property management companies, and $200M+ in application fees between them.

- Sole PM for the application line: strategy and roadmap for applicants and property managers across two codebases that ship together. The payer and the user are different people, and the product has to serve both. Every customer runs its own configuration, so each change had to hold across thousands of setups.
- Rebuilt the rental application end to end. Submission rate went from **44% to 70%** with a **zero change-failure rate**, and units on the new flow fill **3.4 days faster** than offline workflows.
- Redesigned the payment step, built on AppFolio's internal payments API, around how callbacks actually arrive. Modeled the latency tail, moved the wait from 8 to 12 seconds, and sent the long tail to an authenticated recovery link instead of a longer spinner. Timeouts fell from ~8% to ~4%; payment completion reached **about 99%**.
- Built an API that moves applicant PII between platforms to pre-fill applications. Launched with Zillow and reached 70% customer adoption, then pushed to wind it down: volume went up, and property managers got buried in unqualified applicants. More applicants did not mean better matches.
- Built a verified jobs-to-be-done map from **50–100 customer calls a year**: one shared model of what renters and property managers need, later the corpus for an internal RAG tool. Every product bet traces back to it.
- Shipped follow-up for incomplete applications inside the authenticated app, not over email or text, so every interaction stays auditable for fair-housing compliance. Customer satisfaction on rental applications rose **18%**.
- Moved my team to spec-driven work: behavior written and pressure-tested before code, every release gated on tests and evals.

Lively · *Data Scientist → Product Manager*

Nov 2019 – Dec 2022

HSA platform. Partners on one side, account holders on the other, money moving between banks underneath.

- Built the partner APIs and migration pipelines that moved **$50M+ in HSA assets** across financial institutions with **zero data loss**, cutting the work from two migration teams to one.
- Built the platform under it: money movement across banks and card networks, processor integrations, ledgers, and the data model partners built on, so they could offer compliant HSA accounts without building the infrastructure themselves.
- Stood up the first data-science function and data platform; promoted to PM in 2021 as the work became the roadmap.

Oracle · *Data Scientist, Applied Research*

Sep 2017 – Sep 2019

- Rebuilt the model-validation methodology on a representative U.S. population sample, correcting a data skew that had distorted how we measured model performance.
- Automated the ad-viewability pipeline (Python, JIRA API), replacing extraction and cleaning that took two analysts full-time.

Earlier. Second hire at Olivers Apparel, a DTC menswear startup: textile R&D and fabric cost modeling.

SELECTED WORK

Brava (bravamade.com). Recruiting profiles that help women's soccer athletes outside the major metros get seen by college coaches. Built with my brother and live with customers. Coach-verified stats, benchmark rankings, an AI-assisted production pipeline. Designed and shipped it myself, from the first research call to the brand on the page.

AbiertoClaw (github.com/be-ns/AbiertoClaw). Open-source AI agent that runs our family calendar over iMessage. A complexity router and a daily best-free-model picker keep it free by default.

SKILLS

SQL · Python · Experimentation · Metric design · Payments · Data pipelines & APIs · AI agents, RAG & evals · OOUX

EDUCATION

B.A. Communication Studies, Westmont College · Data Science Immersive (ML), Galvanize